

Write a finding statement

Activity · Results Communication · ~15 min

BEFORE YOU START

- You have a recent FASTR analysis output (chart, table, or interpretation note) in front of you
- You've identified at least one **interesting finding** from it — a change, a pattern, an outlier

WHY THIS MATTERS

Raw findings are easy to *see* but hard to *communicate*. A good finding statement does three things in one or two sentences:

1. Names the **indicator**, **direction**, and **magnitude** of the change
2. Anchors it in **place and period** so the reader knows where and when
3. Adds a brief **interpretation** so the reader knows what it might mean

Without these, a finding lands as "interesting data" — not as something a decision-maker can act on.

The formula

[Indicator] [trend] from [value] to [value] in [place/period]. This suggests [interpretation].

Pick one finding from your FASTR analysis and write it out using the formula. Then read it back — would someone unfamiliar with your data understand what happened and why it matters?

Write your finding here:

Indicator: _____

Trend: _____

From: _____ To: _____

Place / period: _____

This suggests: _____

Worked examples

Weak (result only):

ANC1 was 12,400 in Q1 2026.

Better (uses the formula):

ANC1 visits **dropped 18%** in the Northern Region, **from 14,200 in Q1 2025 to 11,640 in Q1 2026**. This suggests **service disruption** rather than a data quality issue — completeness was stable and the drop is consistent across all districts in the region.

Notice what the better version adds:

 **Sample FASTR output chart — ANC1 trend showing disruption (anchors the worked example)**

`resources/screenshots/m7/sample_anc1_chart.png`

- A ****direction and magnitude**** (dropped 18%) - A ****time comparison**** (Q1 2025 → Q1 2026) - A ****place**** (Northern Region) - An ****interpretation**** that rules out alternatives (data quality)

Pitfalls

"This suggests" is the hardest part. It's tempting to skip — but a finding without interpretation forces the reader to do the work. Take a stand.

- Avoid "interesting" or "concerning" as your interpretation — they're empty. Say *what* is concerning and *why*.
- If you really don't know what it means, say so explicitly: *"This pattern needs further investigation — we are unable to rule out [X] without [Y]."* That's still a defensible position.

Peer check

Swap your finding statement with a colleague. Ask them:

- Can you tell what happened, where, when, and by how much?
- Is the interpretation specific enough to be useful?
- Is there anything you'd want to know that's missing?

What's next

Once your findings are sharp, the next activity is **Link your results to actions** — taking each finding and pairing it with a decision-maker and a concrete next step.